Friction – A contact force (p255-258)

The force that makes most moving objects stop is friction. Friction exists whenever two surfaces are in contact.

What is friction?

1. What happens when you roll a soccer ball along some grass?

2. What force causes the ball to slow down?

3. Why is friction a contact force?

4. Which direction does friction act?

5. Why do two sheets of sandpaper ‘stick’ when you try to slide them?

What affects friction?

1. What two things does friction depend on?

2. How does the weight of an object affect friction?

Useful friction

1. Explain how friction helps you to walk.

2. What other everyday things would you be unable to do without friction?

Unwanted friction

1. What does friction do to moving parts?

2. Friction also produces heat. Why is this bad in an engine?

3. What is air resistance?

Reducing Friction

1. Describe four ways to reduce friction.

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